Yuxuan He

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Education

2022–present	Ph.D. Candidate in Economics, Tilburg University, the Netherlands Supervisors: Jan Potters and Eric van Damme
2022	Research Master in Economics, Tilburg University, the Netherlands, *summa cum laude*
2020	Master in Economics and Finance, Center for Monetary and Financial Studies (CEMFI), Spain
2018	Bachelor of Economics, Sun Yat-Sen University, China

Research Fields

Experimental and Behavioral Economics, Microeconomic Theory

Research Visits

2026	Visiting Scholar, California Institute of Technology, USA Hosts: Thomas Palfrey and Marina Agranov

Job Market Paper

Communication and Information Acquisition in Committees

Many collective decisions rely on costly information acquisition by group members, giving rise to a free-riding problem. This paper examines how pre-vote communication affects this problem. I present a model in which voters with common interests decide whether to acquire private information before voting, and compare institutions with and without an intermediate communication stage. The model identifies two opposing effects: communication raises the incentive to acquire information by allowing a member's signal to influence others' votes (persuasion effect), but lowers it by making others' information a closer substitute for one's own (substitution effect). In equilibrium, communication increases information acquisition and improves group accuracy and welfare when information is relatively expensive, but reduces them when information is relatively cheap. I test these predictions in a pre-registered laboratory experiment with three-member committees. Communication increases acquisition when information is expensive, as predicted, but does not reduce it when information is cheap, and it improves group accuracy and welfare at both cost levels. Additional evidence helps explain the missing downside: subjects recognize the persuasion effect but insufficiently account for the substitution effect, leading them to overvalue information acquisition under communication.

Working Paper

Talk Helps, but Excess Talk Can Hurt: Pre-vote Communication and the Swing Voter's Curse *(submitted)*

This paper investigates the effect of pre-vote communication on collective decision-making when abstention is allowed. We present a model of majority-rule voting with common-interest and asymmetrically informed voters, with and without a communication stage. Communication does not alter the set of equilibrium outcomes. Still, we hypothesize that communication decreases efficiency, based on the conjecture that messages from poorly informed voters dilute those from better-informed voters. Our experimental implementation of the model shows that communication instead improves the efficiency of collective decisions, primarily through an unanticipated mechanism: it curbs irrational voting by less-informed voters. Nevertheless, consistent with our message-dilution conjecture, efficiency is lower when everyone speaks than when the less-informed voters stay silent, because after communication less-informed voters rarely abstain and instead largely vote with the majority message.

Work in Progress

Persuasion with Two-sided Messages (with Jan Potters)

Sequential Deliberation in Committees (with Marina Agranov and Thomas R. Palfrey)

Seminar & Conference Presentations

2026	Caltech Experimental Coffee Hour (Los Angeles), ESA World Meeting (Los Angeles), Tilburg University (Tilburg)
2025	ESA World Meeting (Beijing), BEAT Conference on Behavioral Experimental and Theoretical Economics (Beijing), Berlin Micro Theory and Behavioral Economics PhD Conference (Berlin), World Congress of the Econometric Society (Seoul)
2024	ESA European Meeting (Helsinki), Sun Yat-Sen University (Guangzhou), Tilburg University (Tilburg)
2023	Tilburg University (Tilburg)

Grants and Scholarships

2025	Travel Grant, Economic Theory Summer School, Econometric Society
2020–2022	Koopmans Scholarship, Tilburg University

Teaching Experience

2025–present	T.A., *Microeconomics 1 (Individual Decision Making)*, Ph.D. level, Tilburg University
2022–present	T.A., *Methods: Game Theory 1*, Master's level, Tilburg University
2022–present	T.A., *Methods: Game Theory 2*, Master's level, Tilburg University
2022–2025	T.A., *Micro 4: Industrial Economics*, Bachelor's level, Tilburg University
2022	T.A., *Privacy and Big Data*, Bachelor's level, Tilburg University
2022–present	Supervision of bachelor's theses, Tilburg University

Skills & Languages

Computer	MATLAB, R, Stata, Python, Mathematica, oTree
Languages	Chinese (native), English (fluent)

References

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Prof. Eric van Damme
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Prof. Wieland Müller
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